



In the Age of AI, What Are We Actually Educating Students For?

Humanity and Technology

Council of Liberal Arts Leaders at Technological Universities
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THE SENTENCE WE AGREED ON

**“the future of
higher education in
the age of AI”**

*Named at the first gathering as a
question our kind of partnership can
answer. [Utz \(2026\)](#)*

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Where the conversation is stuck



VOLUME

How much AI content?



PLACEMENT

Where in the sequence?



PERMISSION

When may they use it?

Policy questions. Necessary. Not the hard one.

What does genuine competence in a field demand of a human being?

THE CLAIM

Not how much AI we teach. The depth of the knowledge students bring to it.

AI amplifies what you already know

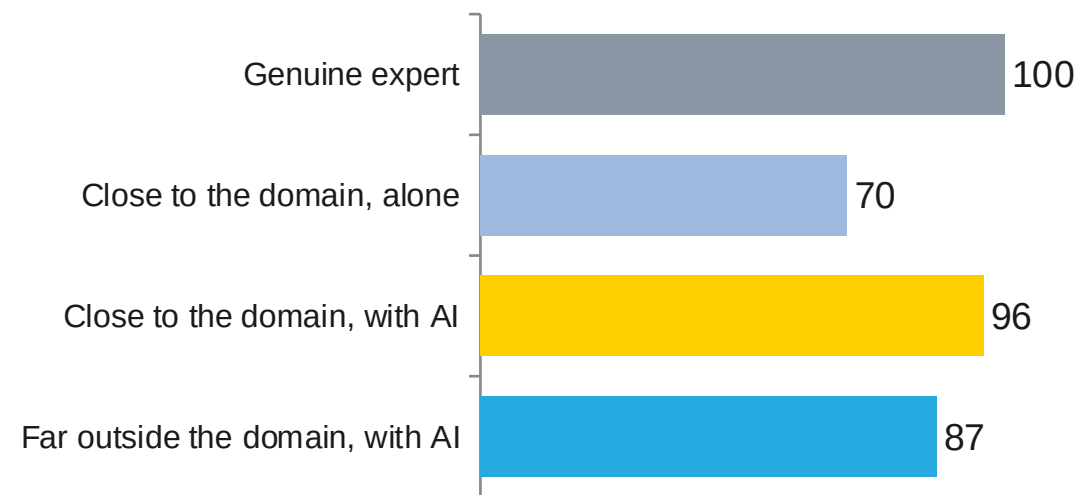
EXPECTED

Teams of AI specialists

FOUND

AI literacy in the hands of people who already had deep domain knowledge

Can the tools supply expertise you never built?



Schematic of the finding, not plotted study data.

AI amplifies what you already know. It does not supply what you do not.

What stays stubbornly human

Useful for iteration. Derivative by design.

01

Designing experiments in genuinely uncertain domains

02

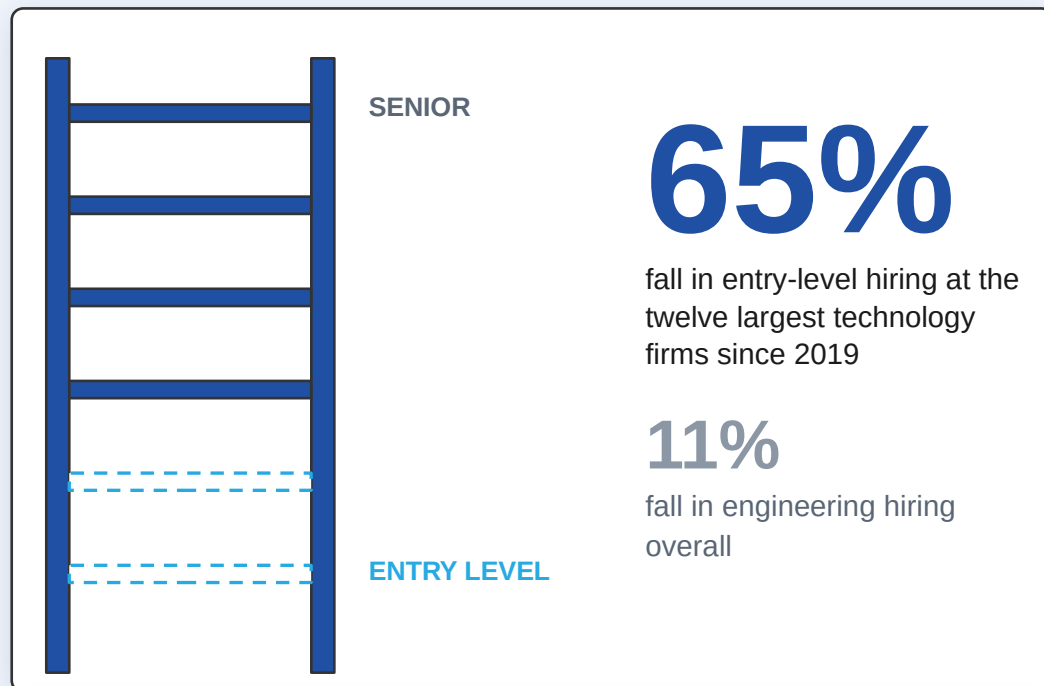
Building hypotheses from first principles, not by recombination

03

Reading the result that does not fit, and knowing why it failed

Not soft skills. The hard skills, and the first thing a compressed curriculum cuts.

The ladder is losing its bottom rungs



The rung was the apprenticeship. Rebuilding it
has to happen inside the curriculum.

THE ROLE NOBODY CAN STAFF
The AI translator

WHAT EMPLOYERS SAY THEY WANT THROUGH 2026



Critical thinking



AI and data literacy



Emotional
intelligence



Adaptability



Creativity

Not a skills profile. A judgment profile.

Why this lands in our units, and what follows

NOT A STEM ARGUMENT WITH A LIBERAL ARTS FOOTNOTE

No computing skill on the employer list.

Distraction is not discipline-specific.

We already live on both sides of the seam.

THREE MOVES

01

Weave AI literacy into the discipline

Name the course where this happens next term.

02

Protect the productive struggle

Name what you would refuse to cut, before you are asked.

03

Rebuild the apprenticeship in the curriculum

Name the place where a student is still allowed to fail.

Which one could you start this term, and what would you stop doing to make room for it?



Over to you

Four questions I would rather argue about than answer alone

01 Does distraction look the same in your unit as it does in mine?

02 Is there an entry-level trap in the humanities and the arts?

03 What has already been compressed out of your programs?

04 If this is our moment, what would we do differently to meet it?

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